

tinguished.³ The aim of the literature is religious, therefore little attention is paid to civil regulations. These are brought under ceremonial rules, and represent the views of the sacerdotal class. They will be treated later. The same is true of secular laws in Judaism. In the Persian government there was a council of state composed of the seven princes who "see the king's face."⁴ Perhaps the seven princes were regarded as representing the seven Amesha Spenta. In the administration there were satraps and prefects, necessitating the employment of posts and means of conveyance. A vivid picture of such an organization is given in Esther.⁵ Herodotus says of the system, "nothing mortal travels so fast."⁶ Twelve parts of the armour of soldiers are enumerated in one section of the Avesta.⁷ A Pahlavi passage spiritualizes the armour of a warrior in a manner worthy of comparison with the familiar Biblical passage.⁸ The Jews, on the other hand, though they had had many warriors and an organized kingdom were not in a real sense political. The determinative element was religious. Their state was a theocracy, their laws were religious and ceremonial.

CASTE. There was no rigid caste system either in

3. Ys. XLVIII:5, 10.

4. Ezra VII:14, Esther I:14.

5. Esther VIII:9-10.

6. Herod VIII:98.

7. Vd. XIV:9, also Yt. XIII:71-72, and Herod VII:61. Vd. XVII:10, Yt. I:18-19, X:39-40, 128-132.

8. Main. Kh. XLIII:7-13, with Isa. LIX:17, Eph. VI:14-17.

Zoroastrianism or in Judaism. But there were classes or orders among the people. The division of the people into priests, warriors, and tillers of the soil frequently is met with in the *Avesta*. The institution of these separate orders is traced to Zarathustra. He is distinctly called the first Priest, the first Warrior, and the first Plougher of the ground.⁹ In the Bundeshesh, the three sons of Zarathustra are connected with these three classes. The first was the head of the priests. The second was the commander-in-chief in war. The third was the chief of the agricultural population.¹⁰ These orders were not castes, for they were not hereditary, nor was inter-marriage forbidden. The three orders are blended by all being derived from Zarathustra. It is implied that a son in any class might be born in the same home.¹¹

An artisan class is also sometimes mentioned.¹² Labor was held in respect. By cultivating a field a man was performing a religious act to the glory of Ahura Mazda. There probably was a servile class, which may have been composed only of captives taken in war. But it seems likely too that a free man might pawn away his freedom.¹³ The spirit and character of the Zoroastrian faith however is against slavery.

9. Yt. XIII:88-89.

10. Bund. XXXII:5.

11. Ys. XI:6.

12. Ys. XIX:17-18, Herod I:125, 101.

13. Vd. IV:2.

These ideas are similar to those in Judaism. In the earlier days the Jews were a nomadic people. They developed into an agricultural and commercial race. There was no warrior class in Judaism. The priesthood stands distinct as an institution, but was not absolutely exclusive. There were Hebrew slaves, but their subjection was limited in time.¹⁴ Slavery was a temporary expedient.

THE PLACE OF WOMAN. The position of woman among the Iranian people was in no way a degrading one. The good deeds of women are alluded to in the same manner as the good deeds of men.¹⁵ There are just men and just women,¹⁶ male and female saints.¹⁷ We find the names of women immortalized for the good they have done.¹⁸ The prayers of bad women are of no avail.¹⁹ In order to marry, the girl should be past her fifteenth year.²⁰ A wife is an honor to the house.²¹ She must be pure and her reputation unstained.²² She is the mistress of the house, just as the husband is the master of the house.²³ She is not his slave but his companion. A maiden longs for a husband, and one who is young, strong, and learned.²⁴ But when Zarathustra is represented as asking

14. Deut. XV:12, Lev. XXV:39. Deut. XXIII:15.

15. Ys. I:16, XIII:7, Yt. XIII:154, also Herod II:1.

16. Ys. VIII:3, XVI:9, LXXI:10, LXVIII:12-13.

17. Ys. VII:27, LVIII:5.

18. Yt. XIII:139-140, 148-149, Ys. XXXVI:8.

19. Yt. XVII:54, 57.

20. Vd. XIV:15.

21. Vd. III:3.

22. Vd. XIV:15.

23. Vd. XII:7, Gals. IV:9.

24. Yt. V:87, XV:40, Vd. III:24.